



Name: _____ Cohort/Batch: _____ Date: _____ Score: _____

HIBERNATE PRACTICE SHEET - 10 CONCEPTUAL Q&A

10 Q&A on ORM, caching, N+1, lazy loading, and migrations

TOTAL: 10 QUESTIONS

Q1 What is Hibernate and how does it map Java objects to database tables? **ORM**

Q6 How do you map a bidirectional @OneToMany relationship? **Annotations**

Q2 Explain the Hibernate entity lifecycle states. **Architecture**

Q7 What is the N+1 select problem and how do you fix it? **Lifecycle**

Q3 What is the difference between Session.get() and Session.load()? **Configuration**

Q8 How does optimistic locking work in Hibernate with @Version? **Versioning**

Q4 What is lazy loading and when does it cause issues? **Hardening**

Q9 What is HQL and how does it differ from SQL and Criteria API? **APIs**

Q5 Describe Hibernate's two levels of caching. **SSO / IdP**

Q10 How do you manage schema migrations with Flyway and Hibernate? **Tuning**



ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATORY SOLUTIONS

Comprehensive verified answers, best-practice configs, security controls & reference

VERIFIED SOLUTIONS

A1 **Hibernate is a JPA-compliant ORM. @Entity marks**

Mitigation

Hibernate is a JPA-compliant ORM. @Entity marks a class as a persistent entity. Field annotations (@Column, @Id) map attributes to columns. At startup Hibernate builds a Metamodel and can auto-generate DDL from the mappings.

A6 **The @OneToMany side uses mappedBy='fieldName' pointing**

pointing

The @OneToMany side uses mappedBy='fieldName' pointing to the owning side. The @ManyToOne side owns the foreign key column. Always update the owning side to persist changes; the inverse side is for navigation only.

A2 **Transient: new object, unknown to Hibernate. Persistent:**

Primitives

Transient: new object, unknown to Hibernate. Persistent: associated with a Session; changes are tracked. Detached: Session closed, changes not tracked. Removed: scheduled for DELETE. Calling session.save() moves transient to persistent.

A7 **N+1 occurs when loading N parent entities**

Automation

N+1 occurs when loading N parent entities then running one query per entity to fetch a child collection. Fix with JOIN FETCH in JPQL (loads all in one query), @EntityGraph, or batch-fetching via @BatchSize on the association.

A3 **get() hits the database immediately and returns**

Hardening

get() hits the database immediately and returns null if not found. load() returns a proxy (lazy placeholder) and defers the SQL hit until a field is accessed. load() throws ObjectNotFoundException at access time if the row is missing.

A8 **Add a @Version Long field to the**

Governance

Add a @Version Long field to the entity. Hibernate includes WHERE version=? in every UPDATE. If another transaction modified the row first, the version no longer matches and Hibernate throws OptimisticLockException, preventing a lost update.

A4 **Lazy loading defers the SQL for associations**

Gotchas

Lazy loading defers the SQL for associations (e.g., @OneToMany) until the collection is accessed. It causes LazyInitializationException when accessed outside an open Session. Fix with JOIN FETCH, @EntityGraph, or keeping the Session open (Open Session in View).

A9 **HQL is object-oriented: queries reference entity names**

Assessment

HQL is object-oriented: queries reference entity names and field names, not table or column names. Hibernate translates HQL to the target SQL dialect. The Criteria API constructs the same queries programmatically in a type-safe manner.

A5 **L1 (Session cache) is always on; identical**

Federation

L1 (Session cache) is always on; identical IDs within one Session return the same object without a second SQL query. L2 (SessionFactory cache, optional) is shared across Sessions; providers include Ehcache and Redis. @Cacheable enables it per entity.

A10 **Set spring.jpa.hibernate.ddl-auto=validate so Hibernate only**

Verification

Set spring.jpa.hibernate.ddl-auto=validate so Hibernate only checks schema matches entities without changing it. Flyway applies versioned SQL scripts (V1__init.sql, V2__add_column.sql) in order, keeping schema changes explicit and auditable.